

Zakiy T. Manigo

+1 (908) 230-6948 | zakiymanigo@gmail.com | NY / NJ | linkedin.com/in/zakiymanigo

I put models that already exist into products people use, with real limits on grounding, cost, latency, and what happens when the model is wrong. That last mile is the job: a proxy, a quota, a human in the loop, and a kill switch on the path the user sees. I completed a Columbia B.S. in Computer Engineering through the Combined Plan and I am based in New York / New Jersey.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

BariAccess Livingston, NJ / Hybrid
June 2025 – Present
Software Engineer

- Served as one of two primary engineers and productized ABA, a medical AI assistant and companion being built for TREI in BariAccess (trei.care), as a fail-closed Azure OpenAI assistant with voice and text sharing one policy path.
- Kept the backend as the authority and the model as a renderer, classifying urgent, clinical, and injection routes before generation.
- Stored keys in Key Vault and encoded rate limits, retention, and medical-claim output checks in code rather than in prompt text alone.
- Held ABA, that medical AI assistant and companion, to approved clinical meaning on public and clinic surfaces through patient-language rules in the product.

City of Elizabeth Elizabeth, NJ
May 2024 – September 2024
Database Engineer Intern

- Administered MongoDB and Excel document stores supporting a knowledge-sharing network used by more than 500 municipal staff.
- Automated reporting pipelines and improved data flow across departments so shared records could be reused without a manual handoff.

PROJECTS

FITD AI Remote
May 2024 – Present
Founder and Engineer

- Put closet and brand labeling, a wardrobe-grounded stylist, and Vertex virtual try-on behind a Cloud Function proxy with keys on the server.
- Ran community bots with human approval, quotas, moderation, and a kill switch on Gemini, Imagen, and Veo so generation stays inside product gates.

Local AI Remote
August 2026 – Present
Product Engineer

- Built an offline GGUF desktop client with documents and retrieval-augmented generation on llama.cpp so inference stays on the machine.
- Kept a fully offline default in which the UI runs local inference as a child process and stores chats in SQLite.

FitGenius Remote
May 2026 – Present
Founding Technical Partner

- Applied Gemini on Vertex AI to fitness under a catalog-constrained coach so answers stay inside allowed context.
- Stripped GPS, health samples, and photos from model payloads before the request leaves the device path.

LaunchPage Studio Remote
October 2025 – Present
Founding Engineer

- Shipped Automotive Operations System as a shop operations platform with role-based access and a delivery playbook so the next client can be stood up from the same path.
- Automated the financial loop the shop already closes using Stripe webhooks and scheduled Cloud Functions on Automotive Operations System.
- Built TaxTracker Pro as a records workspace with tax-year documents, exception reports, and export, with Stripe and store billing jobs behind signature verification.

EDUCATION

Columbia University New York, NY
Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering
May 2025
Fu Foundation Combined Plan 3+2

Computer Architecture, Databases, AI, Embedded Systems, and UI Design

St. Lawrence University Canton, NY
Bachelor of Arts in Mathematics
May 2023

Dean's List, Spring 2022

Calculus, Linear Algebra, Differential Equations, and Group Theory

James Cook University Townsville, QLD, Australia
Undergraduate Exchange
Fall 2022

Statistical Data Mining, Probability and Stochastic Processes, Game Design, and Human Rights

SKILLS/INTERESTS

Skills: Gemini, Vertex AI, Azure OpenAI, llama.cpp / GGUF, prompt packs, kill switches, grounding, TypeScript, Swift, React, Expo, Fastify, Firebase / GCP, Azure, Rust / Tauri

Interests: calisthenics, gym, running, basketball, golf, snowboarding, hiking, skeet, pop/R&B production, cooking, journaling, travel, poker

Community: Siloam-Hope First Presbyterian; NAACP Elizabeth Branch; Supervising Tutor, Central Presbyterian Church